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for the first time, will see a complete demarcation of duties and responsibilities between the parliamentary party leadership and the office bearers looking after the organisation.

There was speculation before the team was announced whether Gadkari would include Modi in the Parliamentary Board, the powerful decision making body of the BJP. He had been kept out by his predecessor Rajnath Singh as Modi was a chief minister. Gadkari chose to continue the trend but included Modi's nominee Purushottam Rupala as a vice-president. He also included Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan's nominee Narendra Singh Tomar as general secretary. Tomar was also president of the state unit, serving as a reminder that the party was awaiting reorganisation even at the state levels. Dhumal's nominee J.P. Nadda was also made a general secretary. Nadda had the

added advantage of having worked with Gadkari during their student days. Among the new entrants in the National Executive were political secretaries of both Rajnath Singh and Gadkari—Sudhanshu Trivedi and Vinay Sahasrabudhe.

Despite Gadkari's efforts at balancing regional aspirations, there were complaints of lack of representation from the southern states. Karnataka Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa failed to get any of his nominees on board. Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh were not adequately represented. There were some surprise entries in the national team and these included J.K. Jain, Mahesh Jethmalani and Gurjar leader Kirori Singh Bainsla, who had made things difficult for Raje during her tenure as chief minister, demanding reservations for his community. Perhaps, it is an indication of yet another balancing act by Gadkari.

Gadkari has not created a fighting machine. He has allowed himself to be assisted by those who have lost the fight already. ■

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